

5 Things I'd Do to Lose 10 Pounds in 30 Days

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Aug 19, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Uisv93gC-Tc> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

A 27-year certified personal trainer and nutritionist outlines an extreme, math-driven 5-step fat-loss protocol—daily 20,000-step walking, full-body weight training, aggressive calorie and protein targets, strategic supplements, and doctor-supervised peptides—designed to shed 10+ lbs in 30 days.

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The Fat-Loss Math Foundation 0:46

- Fat loss is purely a calorie equation: burn more than you consume
 - Every pound of fat requires a **3,500-calorie deficit** to eliminate
- There are four mechanisms the body uses to burn calories:
 - **BMR (Basal Metabolic Rate)** — calories burned just keeping you alive (breathing, organ function); responsible for 60–70% of total daily caloric burn
 - **Thermogenic Effect of Food (TEF)** — calories burned digesting food; protein has by far the highest TEF (see Step 3)
 - **Exercise** — typically only 5% of total daily caloric burn
 - **NEAT (Non-Exercise Activity Thermogenesis)** — calories burned from all movement that isn't structured exercise (tapping a foot, walking to the car, playing catch)
 - Brandon considers this the most powerful lever because, unlike exercise, the body doesn't need recovery time from NEAT, so it can be dialed up indefinitely

Step 1: Walk 20,000 Steps Per Day (NEAT) 2:20

- Target: **20,000 steps every single day** — deliberately amplifying NEAT
- Caloric payoff: the average person burns **800–1,000 extra calories per day** at 20,000 steps

- At 1,000 calories/day × 7 days = **7,000 extra calories burned per week = 2 lbs of fat per week**
- Over 4 weeks = **8 lbs of fat** from walking alone
- How to hit 20,000 steps without a dedicated block of time:
 - Morning: walk **30 minutes immediately after waking** → ~3,000 steps
 - Lunch break: spend 30 minutes eating, then **walk 30 minutes** → ~3,000 steps
 - After work: **walk for 1 hour** → ~6,000 steps
 - During work hours (cheat code): **set an alarm every hour and walk for 10 minutes** around the office or block → accounts for remaining ~8,000 steps
- Key principle: **spread the walking throughout the day** rather than doing it all in one session, so the body doesn't need recovery time from it

Step 2: 3–4 Full-Body Lifting Sessions Per Week 4:40

- Brandon does exclusively full-body workouts and has for over 10 years
- Structure: **1–2 exercises per body part, 3–4 sets each**
- To keep sessions to 60–90 minutes, two rules are non-negotiable:
 - **Time every rest period** — use a watch/phone timer; rest only 60–90 seconds between sets
 - **Superset opposing muscle groups** — go directly from one muscle group to its antagonist with zero rest, then rest 60–90 seconds before repeating
 - Example pairing: bench press → immediately bent-over rows → rest → repeat
 - Opposing pairs: chest/back, biceps/triceps
 - Legs: Brandon doesn't superset legs; just squats or leg press, no isolation needed
- Exercise selection: **prioritize compound movements exclusively**
 - Examples: bench press, bent-over rows, overhead press, leg press, pull-ups, squats, dips
 - Isolation movements only acceptable for extremities: bicep curls, tricep extensions, calf raises
 - "Unless you're a pro bodybuilder or physique competitor, isolation movements are kind of worthless in my opinion."
- Beginner bonus: if you have been training less than one year, it is possible to **build muscle and burn fat simultaneously** while following this protocol; after a year of consistent training this becomes much harder

Step 3: Dial In Calories and Protein 6:38

- **Calorie target: current bodyweight (lbs) × 10 = daily calories**
 - Example: 200 lb person eats 2,000 calories/day
 - Use **current** bodyweight, not goal bodyweight
 - This formula alone creates a meaningful caloric deficit
- **Protein target: minimum 1 gram per pound of current bodyweight per day**
 - Brandon personally eats 250–300 g/day at 197 lbs

- Without sufficient protein on a deep deficit, muscle wastes away and bones lose density
- Protein's unique fat-loss advantages beyond muscle preservation:
 - Highest thermogenic effect of any macronutrient — body burns **20–30% of protein calories just digesting it** (eat 100 cal of protein, only absorb 70–80 cal)
 - Burns **3× more calories digesting protein than fat**, and **2× more than carbohydrates**
 - Most satiating macronutrient — keeps hunger suppressed longer
 - Functions like a "cashback carb": you consume the calories but don't fully absorb them
- Fat and carb breakdown: Brandon doesn't prescribe specifics — prioritize hitting calories and protein, then fill the rest however you prefer (keto, high-carb, etc.)
 - Brandon has been keto for 11 consecutive years but says it's not mandatory
- **Tracking is mandatory** — Brandon tracks calories in Claude (the AI):
 - Takes a photo of food or describes it in chat; Claude tallies macros and keeps a running daily log
 - Prompt available (link in description) that gives end-of-day breakdown of calories, protein, net carbs, fat, and caloric burn (linked to Apple Health)
 - Cut-day example shown: 1,700 calories, 207 g protein, 40 g net carbs, 77 g fat, ~3,200 calories burned → **1,500-calorie deficit**
- Case study — Corey Armstrong (student in Brandon's High Ticket Trainer program):
 - Was stuck under \$10K/month as an online trainer partly because he was visibly out of shape
 - Followed this exact protocol, got shredded, then crossed \$10K/month
 - Last year earned **\$400,000 as an online trainer**

Step 4: Creatine, Caffeine, and Protein Shakes 17:21

- **Protein shakes** — not magic, but the best calorie-to-protein ratio available
 - Especially useful on a GLP (appetite suppressed) since you may not feel like eating solid food but can still drink a shake
 - Brandon's cut meal structure: 2 real meals (breakfast + dinner) + protein shakes throughout the day to keep calories low and protein high
- **Creatine — 20 grams per day** (Brandon's personal dose)
 - Standard bodybuilding advice is 5 g/day for muscle building, but Brandon takes 4× that
 - Higher doses benefit **brain health and mood** beyond just muscle retention
 - On this cut, creatine helps **preserve muscle mass** while in a deep deficit
 - "Everybody should take creatine. Even if you're not working out, you should take creatine. It's just that good for your brain."
- **Caffeine** — proven in studies to directly aid fat burning
 - Brandon takes 600–1,000 mg/day (his own extreme, built up over decades; he cautions you don't need to match that)
 - His daily caffeine schedule:

- 300 mg first thing in the morning
- Another 300 mg after lunch before the 30-minute walk
- Additional pre-workout before gym sessions
- Start with whatever dose works for you; the fat-burning and energy benefits are real at any reasonable dose



Step 5: Doctor-Supervised Peptides (GLP-1 + Tesamorelin) 11:41

- **Disclaimer (repeated multiple times):** talk to your doctor before doing anything related to this section; Brandon is not a medical professional
- **GLP-1 agonist — Tirzepatide (Mounjaro/Zepbound)**
 - Brandon has been on Tirzepatide for several months
 - Describes it as the most powerful fat-loss tool he has encountered in nearly 3 decades in fitness
 - Primary effect: **completely eliminates hunger and cravings** with no accompanying fatigue or weakness
 - Analogy: "Dieting without a GLP is like going to the library and typing on a typewriter. Dieting with Tirzepatide feels like my son on the iPad."
 - Brandon stays on a low maintenance dose even when not cutting because he enjoys the mental freedom from food obsession
 - Critical warning: because hunger is suppressed, you must **force yourself to hit protein targets** — accidental starvation (too few calories + too little protein) will cause muscle wasting and bone density loss
 - Recommends it to his mother and all friends who struggle with dietary discipline
 - Notes Ozempic (semaglutide/Rybelsus) requires a prescription the same way — always get from a doctor, never a shady website
- **Tesamorelin (growth-hormone-releasing peptide)**
 - Also requires a doctor's prescription
 - In an FDA trial, proven to **reduce visceral/belly fat** (originally tested in HIV patients)
 - Additional effects Brandon personally reports:
 - Noticeably improved ab definition
 - Dramatically better sleep — "I have never slept better in my life" — confirmed by Oura Ring sleep data
 - Increases growth hormone
 - "I would take it just for the sleep alone even if it wasn't proven to reduce belly fat."

The single biggest insight: NEAT (walking 20,000 steps/day) alone can burn 8 lbs of fat in a month — more impactful than structured cardio — and combining it with aggressive protein intake and GLP-1 suppression makes the entire protocol nearly effortless compared to traditional dieting.